LEADSTRATEGUS | EXECUTIVE PLAYBOOK

EXPO TO FUNNEL

The Event to Pipeline Operating System

How B2B teams choose the right show out of 17,000, turn an attendee list into a shortlist of buyers worth meeting, fill the calendar before the floor opens, brief every conversation, and stay accountable for pipeline for 90 days.

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FREE EVENT RANKING

www.expotofunnel.com

Rank 17,000+ B2B trade shows by how many of your buyers actually attend. Free, in 90 seconds.

WHY THIS DOCUMENT EXISTS

The best channel in B2B, run badly.

For as long as B2B revenue has been measured, trade shows and industry events have been the highest converting channel available to a sales team. Nothing else assembles a buying group, a competitor set and a live category conversation in one room for three days. The channel is not the problem. The execution is.

Across the 50 plus events we have supported over the last eight years, the failure pattern repeats almost word for word. Budget is approved late. The target list is a badge scan file. Outreach starts the week before, if it starts at all. The team lands with an empty calendar and relies on footfall. Follow up is a bulk email on the Monday after, written by someone who was not in the room. The show is judged on scan volume, and next year's decision is made on a feeling rather than on pipeline. That is an execution gap, not a channel problem, and it is worth a great deal of money to close.

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS

This is the LeadStrategus method written down: the sequence of decisions we run for clients, the number ranges we use to judge each one, and the artefact that has to exist before the next stage begins. It covers how we select an event, extract the full attendee universe, cut it to the buyers worth meeting, run contextual outreach, brief every single meeting with speaking points, and convert conversations into 90 day pipeline.

It is written for the CEO, CRO, CMO or founder who owns the number and signs the event budget. Start with the free ranking at **expotofunnel.com**, then use this document to decide what to do with the six shows it returns.

WHY THE READER SHOULD TRUST THIS PLAYBOOK

17,000+
B2B trade shows indexed across 130 countries, ranked by ICP density and free to search.

8+
years of event ABM execution

50+
events supported worldwide, including Dreamforce, MEDICA, Gartner Symposium and BSMA

12
Fortune 50 opportunities opened at a single summit

760
qualified prospects built from one show, from 10,000 records extracted

US$1M
indicative pipeline from a typical large format event programme, alongside 50+ meetings

IMPORTANT Programme outcomes shown throughout this document are selected examples, not guarantees. Results vary with event fit, offer strength, reference depth, target account density and execution runway.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY | PAGE 1 OF 2

The argument, and the funnel it produces.

Six things worth taking from this document before you approve the next event budget.

01 **Choose on buyer density, not brand.** A 30,000 visitor flagship at 3 per cent ICP density is worth less to you than a 2,000 person vertical show at 15 per cent. Popularity is not a proxy for pipeline.

02 **The calendar is built, not found.** Meetings secured before the floor opens convert at several times the rate of booth footfall, because the buyer arrived intending to have the conversation.

03 **One badge is not a buying group.** Gartner puts B2B buying groups at 5 to 16 people across as many as four functions. Outreach aimed at a single contact is aimed at a fraction of the decision.

04 **Context, not charm, wins the room.** Every confirmed meeting gets a written brief: who they are, what changed at their company, why now, the opening question and the honest watchout.

05 **Follow up is designed in week eight, not day four.** The owner, the segment, the channel and the 24 hour SLA are written before anyone travels. Follow up invented after the show is follow up that does not happen.

06 **Measure at 90 days, not at the closing party.** Badge scans are an input. Qualified opportunities, buying group coverage and pipeline are the evidence that the event deserved its capital.

> THE CONCLUSION
>
> **An event is not a three day campaign. It is an account based growth programme that starts 6 to 8 weeks before the doors open and stays accountable for pipeline for at least 90 days after they close.**

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY | PAGE 2 OF 2

From 17,000 events to a room of named buyers.

The full path, with the number ranges we work to. Stage one is free on the platform. Stages two to six are the programme.

17,000+ B2B events indexed, 130 countries	
6 shows shortlisted by ICP density	FREE ON THE PLATFORM
1 event approved through the fit gate	STAGE 1 SELECT
3,000 to 5,000 attendees extracted	STAGE 2 BUILD
200 to 300 ICP matched prospects, tiered	STAGE 2 BUILD
40 to 60 live conversations	STAGE 3 BOOK
10 to 25 briefed meetings	STAGE 4 BRIEF
90 days of accountability	STAGE 6 CONVERT

01 FIND

17,000+ shows ranked by how many of your buyers attend, with the reasoning for every pick.

You, self serve and free · 90 seconds

02 MEET

Universe extracted, cut to 200 to 300 ICP matches, contextual outreach run, meetings booked.

LeadStrategus team · 6 to 8 weeks

03 TALK

A speaking points brief per meeting, command centre on the ground, 90 day follow through.

LeadStrategus team · show week plus 90 days

SECTION 01 | THE EVIDENCE

What the evidence says about event ROI.

Four findings that should shape an event decision before any of our method is applied. Three come from published B2B research. The fourth is the pattern in our own programme data across 50 plus events, and it points the same way.

GARTNER

Buying groups need consensus, not a champion

Gartner finds B2B buying groups can span 5 to 16 people across as many as four functions, and that groups reaching consensus are 2.5 times more likely to report a high quality deal. Event outreach must map the buying group, not chase a single badge.

`Implication: multi thread every Tier 1 account.`

MCKINSEY

The show sits inside an omnichannel journey

McKinsey reports B2B buyers use an average of ten channels across a purchase journey. A trade show should connect research, LinkedIn, email, in person conversation and post event content rather than run as an isolated three day campaign.

`Implication: judge the event by how far it advances the account.`

CEIR AND CVENT

Follow up is designed before the doors open

CEIR recommends deciding ownership, channel mix and lead routing before the show. Cvent advises fast, conversation specific, multi touch follow up. Both point to the same conclusion: the operating system has to be loaded before the team travels.

`Implication: write the follow up in week 8.`

LEADSTRATEGUS PROGRAMME DATA

Activity is not the commercial outcome

Across our events the measures that predict revenue are qualified meetings, buying group coverage, opportunities created and pipeline over time. Badge scan volume correlates with effort, not with pipeline. It is an input, never proof of return.

`Implication: report at 30, 60 and 90 days.`

THE CONCLUSION THESE FOUR POINT TO

Every one of these findings pushes the decisive work earlier. Consensus has to be built before the meeting. Channels have to be sequenced before the week. Follow up has to be owned before travel. Which is why the event programme starts 6 to 8 weeks out and does not end when the stand comes down.

Sources: Gartner Sales Survey, May 2025. McKinsey Global B2B Pulse research, 2024 to 2026. CEIR exhibition follow up guidance. Cvent event lead generation and follow up guidance. Full references on the closing page.

SECTION 02 | THE SYSTEM

The Expo to Funnel operating system.

Six stages, one accountable owner per stage, and a specific artefact that has to exist before the next stage starts. This is what we run for clients, and what a capable internal team can run for itself.

STAGE	WHAT IT DECIDES	OWNER	EVIDENCE AT HAND OFF
1 SELECT	Choose the right event on ICP density, account value, buying group reach and break even economics.	CEO or CRO	Completed Event Fit Score with a scenario range
2 BUILD	Create the account universe: identify best fit audiences who are in the market to buy, through enrichment, triggers and proof points.	Research lead	Tiered account and contact universe
3 BOOK	Start contextual outreach 6 to 8 weeks early, personalised by account and buying group. VIPs are personalised individually, one message written per person.	Campaign lead	Live sequence, named owner per Tier 1 account
4 BRIEF	Write speaking points for every confirmed meeting: context, trigger, angle, opening question, defined win and the honest watchout.	Intelligence lead	One brief per meeting, delivered 48 hours out
5 EXECUTE	Protect the calendar and the context. Confirm, recover no shows, refresh intelligence and capture every conversation.	Command centre	Daily meeting log with owner and next step
6 CONVERT	Follow up and measure. Prioritise within 24 hours, run multi channel sequences, report 30, 60 and 90 day pipeline.	Sales leader	Segmented follow up plus the 90 day review

THE DECISION RULE, STATED PRECISELY

The rule is a gate, not a preference. No money is committed until the owner of each of the six stages can put evidence on the table: a completed fit score, a tiered account universe, a launched sequence with named owners, a briefing template, a staffed command centre and a written, segmented follow up plan.

A stage with no evidence is treated as a stage that will not happen, because in practice it does not. A strong booth cannot compensate for a weak account universe, late outreach or unowned follow up. If the gate cannot be passed with 6 weeks to go, the correct decision is to attend small with a narrow list, or to defer and redirect the spend. It is not to fund it and hope.

The five CEO gate questions, and the number ranges we use to answer them, are set out in Section 03.

SECTION 03 | SELECT

Select on buyer density, not popularity.

Five questions decide whether an event gets funded. Each one has a number attached, because an event decision made on adjectives is a decision made on nothing.

THE CEO GATE QUESTION	THE RANGE WE LOOK FOR	DECISION SIGNAL
1. Are enough high fit accounts and buying roles in the room?	8 per cent or more of attendees match the ICP. At least 100 to 150 target accounts present, and 3 or more relevant buying roles per priority account.	Below 4 per cent density, or under 60 target accounts, defer.
2. Can we identify and reach the buying group before the event?	250 or more contactable ICP records after enrichment, with 60 per cent or more reachable on at least two channels.	Under 40 per cent reachability, attend only with organiser or partner data access.
3. Is there enough runway to build meetings rather than depend on footfall?	6 to 8 weeks minimum from approval to show. Outreach live by week 5 at the latest.	Under 4 weeks, cut to a narrow executive list. Do not fund a full activation.
4. Do we have relevant proof, account context and clear ownership?	At least 2 credible references in the segment. One named owner per Tier 1 account, and no more than 15 to 25 Tier 1 accounts per attending rep.	No named owner means no Tier 1 account. Cut the list, do not stretch the team.
5. Is the follow up sequence written, segmented and assigned before travel?	Hot, warm and nurture sequences drafted. A 24 hour SLA on hot leads. 100 per cent of leads with an owner before departure.	Unwritten follow up at week 1 is a gate failure, not a detail.

Four failure modes we see most often

COMPETITOR MIMICRY	BADGE SCAN ECONOMICS	LATE ACTIVATION	SINGLE CONTACT THINKING
The event is approved because competitors attend. Their presence is evidence about their strategy, not about your pipeline.	The case is built on visitor volume. A 30,000 visitor show at 3 per cent density puts fewer buyers in reach than a 2,000 person show at 15 per cent.	Sponsorship is signed after the research and booking window has closed. By week 3 the achievable meeting count has usually halved.	One person per account when the decision needs four functions. The champion cannot move it internally and it stalls after the show.

WHERE THE PLATFORM DOES THIS FOR YOU

Stage one is free. expotofunnel.com ranks 17,000 plus B2B trade shows across 130 countries against your ICP, deal size and target geography, and returns the six shows where your buyers are densest, with the reasoning behind each pick. That is the SELECT stage of this playbook, run in 90 seconds, at no cost. Everything from Section 04 onward is the programme that turns that shortlist into meetings.

SECTION 04 | BUILD

From an attendee list to buyers worth meeting.

This is the stage almost nobody runs properly, and it is where the return is actually created. The objective is not a bigger list. It is a smaller, correct one: best fit audiences who are in the market to buy, established through enrichment, triggers and proof points.

The reduction, on a real shaped example

A 4,200 delegate industry event, worked from raw registration data to a briefed target list.

STEP	COUNT	WHAT WE DO AT THIS STEP
Extract	4,200	Attendee, exhibitor, speaker, sponsor and session data assembled from every available surface.
Deduplicate	2,850 companies	Collapse to unique organisations, resolve entity names, remove agencies, competitors and non buyers.
Firmographic fit	640 companies	Filter on industry, size, geography, technology environment and growth context against the client ICP.
Active signal	310 companies	Keep only accounts showing a trigger: hiring, leadership change, funding, launch, expansion, filing or platform shift.
Named prospects	260 people	Map the buying roles inside those accounts and enrich to a contactable record with at least two channels.
Tiered	45 / 95 / 120	Tier 1, Tier 2 and Tier 3, each with a treatment, an owner and a realistic meeting target.

Where the universe comes from

- Registration, exhibitor and sponsor directories, plus the published delegate and partner lists.
- Speaker and session rosters, which are the single richest source. A confirmed speaker is a named, verified, motivated attendee with a public topic to open on.
- Event apps, attendee communities, organiser networking platforms, and the social event graph of people publicly announcing attendance.
- Organiser and partner data access where the sponsorship tier provides it.
- Our own index of 17,000 plus events, which carries the attendance history and account overlap of prior editions.

SECTION 04 | BUILD

Four layers of event intelligence

LAYER 1 ACCOUNT FIT	LAYER 2 BUYING ROLES	LAYER 3 CURRENT SIGNALS	LAYER 4 CONVERSATION PROOF
Industry, size, geography, technology environment and the growth or transformation context the company is in.	Economic buyer, functional buyer, technical evaluator, end user and internal champion, mapped as a group.	Hiring, leadership change, launch, expansion, funding, partnership, filing language or platform shift, each with a source link.	One relevant client reference, one quantified outcome, one point of view worth hearing and one question worth answering.
Listed, 439 sites, 22 per cent growth, scaling to 1,000 by 2032.	Builder is reachable, budget sits one level up at VP or CDO.	Digital infrastructure named a strategic priority in the Q1 earnings call.	Four comparable builds, and the two workstreams that broke first in each.

Row two shows the same four layers filled in for a real account, redacted. Every signal carries a live source link in the delivered brief.

Tier the universe, then treat the tiers differently

Tiering is not administrative. It decides where human writing time goes, and human writing time is the scarce resource in the whole programme.

TIER	TYPICAL SIZE	DEFINITION AND TREATMENT	CHANNELS	MEETING RATE
Tier 1	30 to 50 accounts	Highest fit, active signal, reachable buying group. Named owner, multi threaded across 2 to 3 roles, executive involvement, full account brief. Every message written by a human for that individual.	LinkedIn, email, phone, session hook	25% to 40%
Tier 2	80 to 120 accounts	Strong fit with a moderate signal, or partial reachability. Personalised by role and trigger, standard proof points, meeting target set where a response emerges.	LinkedIn and email	8% to 15%
Tier 3	100 to 150 accounts	Potential fit but a weak signal or low reachability. Light nurture, event content, opportunistic engagement on the floor and a post event sequence.	Email and content	2% to 5%

VIPS ARE PERSONALISED INDIVIDUALLY

Speakers, panellists, board level attendees and named strategic accounts do not enter a sequence. Each one gets a message written by a person, for that person, referencing their session, their announcement, their filing or their number. Nothing templated reaches a VIP, and nothing is sent to a VIP that the sender could not defend in the room. This is roughly 15 to 25 people per event, and it is where the disproportionate outcomes come from: the 12 Fortune 50 opportunities we opened at one summit all began as individually written notes to named people, not as a campaign.

Gartner implication: personalisation should help the buying group build a shared business case. Avoid over personalising around one individual's priorities when the decision needs cross functional consensus. The most useful thing you can give a champion is something they can forward to a peer in another function without editing it.

SECTION 05 | BOOK

Contextual outreach that earns the slot.

Context creates the meeting. Relevance converts the conversation. Every message we send passes five tests before it leaves, and the sequence is built to run across channels over six weeks rather than as a pre show blast.

The message architecture

ELEMENT	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE
1. Signal	A recent, verifiable, company or role specific observation. Never a generic industry trend.	You are opening roughly one site a week to hit the 2032 target.
2. Relevance	Why that issue connects naturally to your value and to the event context.	Your Q1 filing named digital infrastructure as a priority.
3. Proof	One client, one result or one practical point of view that reduces perceived risk.	In four comparable scale ups, the architecture held and the engineering capacity did not.
4. Ask	A low friction request with a clear reason to spend 20 minutes, tied to a date.	Worth 20 minutes on the Tuesday to compare where your team is feeling that?
5. Continuity	A useful next touch on a different channel that adds something. Never the same copy resent.	You are presenting at 4:10. I will be in that room and will find you after.

The channel cadence

Five to seven touches across three channels over six weeks. McKinsey's omnichannel finding applied literally: the sequence is layered week over week, not fired once.

WEEK	CHANNEL	MOVE	PURPOSE
W-6	LinkedIn	Follow, engage with a post, connection request with one line of context	Warm the name before anything is asked
W-5	Email	Message 1: signal, relevance, proof, soft ask	Establish that this is not a mail merge
W-4	LinkedIn	Share or send one genuinely relevant proof point or point of view	Give before asking a second time
W-3	Email	Message 2: the event hook and two concrete slots	Convert interest into a diarised time
W-2	Phone or LinkedIn	Second channel on non responders, referencing their session or agenda	Break through inbox volume
W-1	Email	Confirmation, logistics, and the agenda for the conversation	Reduce no shows before they happen

EXPECTED RESPONSE RATES

On a well built universe we expect 12 to 25 per cent response on Tier 1, 6 to 12 per cent on Tier 2 and 2 to 5 per cent on Tier 3. From 260 shortlisted prospects that is typically 40 to 60 live conversations and 10 to 25 confirmed meetings. If Tier 1 response is under 8 per cent by week 3, the problem is almost always the signal quality in the message, not the volume.

SECTION 06 | BRIEF

Nobody walks into a meeting cold.

A confirmed meeting is only half the asset. The other half is knowing exactly what to say in the first ninety seconds. For every meeting we book, we write a speaking points brief and deliver it 48 hours before the slot, refreshed within 24 hours of it.

The anatomy of a speaking points brief

BLOCK	WHAT IT CONTAINS	WHY IT IS THERE
Identity	Name, title, company, employee size, revenue, contact detail, availability and confirmed session.	So the executive can recognise and find them.
About the company	Six to eight lines: what they do, scale, growth rate, current strategic goal, relevant platform estate.	Context in one read, no research on the plane.
Conversation history	Exactly what was said, by whom, on which channel, and what was and was not agreed.	Continuity. The meeting resumes, it does not restart.
Signals	Hiring, technology and strategic signals, each with a live source link.	Gives a verifiable opening that is not small talk.
Tier and justification	Why this person, why now, and the honest watchout on authority or timing.	Prevents the wrong conversation with the right company.
Speaking points	Three or four openers in the client's own voice, each with the reason it works.	Usable verbatim under pressure.
The defined win	One sentence on what a successful conversation actually produces.	Turns a chat into a next step.
Sessions and sources	Recommended sessions with times and the rationale, plus every source link.	Puts your executive in the right room at the right hour.

EVERY BRIEF NAMES THE LIMITATION

In the example opposite, the contact is a builder and an internal champion, not a budget holder. The brief says so plainly, and states that the path runs through a peer conversation to a VP or CDO referral. A brief that contains only good news walks your executive into the wrong conversation with the right company. The watchout is the most valuable line on the page.

SECTION 06 | BRIEF

A speaking points brief, partially redacted

An extract from a live brief prepared for a client attending a global data and AI summit. Account and individual identifiers are redacted, and everything else is exactly as delivered. One brief per confirmed meeting, issued 48 hours ahead and refreshed within 24 hours of the slot.

SPEAKING POINTS

Name: [redacted] **Designation:** Senior Manager, Data Engineering

Company: [redacted] **Employee size:** 12,900 **Revenue:** US$1.17bn

Availability: Confirmed speaker, session on multi agent supervisor architecture

ABOUT THE COMPANY

[redacted] is a listed multi site operator with 439 locations, FY25 revenue of US$1.17bn and 22.5 per cent year on year growth. Founded 2006, headquartered in [redacted]. Targeting 1,000+ sites by 2032. Runs an internal data engineering function supporting operations, loyalty, finance and HR analytics.

CONVERSATION HISTORY

[redacted] reached out after seeing the contact listed as a 2026 summit speaker. He responded warmly, indicated willingness to connect around the session, and confirmed he would be on site both days. No formal meeting locked at the time of writing.

HIRING, TECHNOLOGY AND STRATEGIC SIGNALS

- Hiring signal: an open Lead Data Scientist role posted in the last 30 days.
- Platform signal: four production analytics workspaces across finance, operations, customer analytics and HR, plus structured streaming and multi agent orchestration in live use.
- Strategic signal: digital revenue mix reached 37.9 per cent in FY25 and 39.9 per cent in Q1 26. Digital infrastructure and new platforms named a strategic priority in the Q1 26 earnings call.

`Sources: two live links attached in the delivered brief.`

TIER AND THE HONEST WATCHOUT

Tier: Medium. Confirmed speaker and a production builder, but the seniority limits procurement authority. The path is a peer conversation leading to a VP or CDO referral, not a direct sale. The trigger is unusually strong: the system he is presenting is in production, not pilot, which is exactly the work our client does.

SPEAKING POINTS

- Attend his session first. Open on his own work: which was hardest, the supervisor logic, hallucination prevention, or earning trust with non technical staff? Shows real depth and starts on his terms.
- Probe scale pressure. You are going from 439 to 1,000 sites. Does the architecture scale linearly, or are there parts that start to break at 2x volume? Surfaces the real challenge and where capacity gaps appear.
- Position without pitching. We build production systems of this type for enterprise clients. Are there specific workstreams where specialist capacity would help as you scale? Direct and honest.

The win: he names one workstream under pressure at scale. That becomes the basis for a scoped follow up with him and whoever owns the VP or CDO function in the room.

RECOMMENDED SESSIONS

Three sessions with times and a rationale for each: his own session as the meeting trigger, plus two adjacent sessions that create shared reference points afterwards.

[redacted]

SECTION 07 | EXECUTE

The virtual command centre.

A show floor is a hostile environment for administration. Signal is poor, the schedule moves, people are late, sessions overrun, and the most valuable conversation of the week happens in a corridor. The command centre exists so none of that lands on the person who is supposed to be selling.

Two clocks running at once

This is the coordination logic, and it is the part most teams never build. Every meeting sits in one of five states: confirmed, at risk, in progress, captured, or routed, and the command centre runs two clocks at once. The backward clock closes out the conversation that has just finished, within fifteen minutes, while the detail is still accurate. The forward clock prepares the conversation that has not happened yet, on a rolling 48 hour horizon. A field team cannot run both clocks and also be present in the room. That single fact is the entire justification for the function.

POINT IN TIME	FORWARD CLOCK: THE NEXT MEETING	BACKWARD CLOCK: THE LAST MEETING
T minus 48h	Brief written and delivered. Slot, location and attendee confirmed in writing.	Meeting happens at T zero.
T minus 24h	Brief refreshed with overnight news, agenda changes and any new signal. Reconfirmation sent.	
T minus 2h	Location, contact number and arrival route pushed to the rep. Standby contact identified.	
T plus 15 min	Next brief surfaced with the walking route.	3-2-1 capture completed by the person who was in the room.
T plus 2h		Lead classified hot, warm or nurture. Owner assigned. Next step dated and logged.
T plus 24h		Hot follow up sent personally by the person who met them, referencing the conversation.

Four roles, held by named people

CALENDAR LEAD	ACCOUNT INTELLIGENCE LEAD	CONVERSATION CAPTURE LEAD	FOLLOW UP LEAD
Confirms slots, manages movements, chases reconfirmations, resolves no shows and protects recovery time in the schedule.	Refreshes news, triggers, stakeholder changes and likely discussion angles. Rewrites the brief when something moves overnight.	Ensures every meaningful interaction, including corridor and booth conversations, has context, an owner and a dated next step.	Routes hot, warm and cold actions to the right sequence and owner, and checks CRM completion before the day closes.
Owns: the meeting count actually held.	Owns: no executive walks in with stale context.	Owns: nothing said at the show is lost.	Owns: the 24 hour SLA on hot leads.

THE OPERATING PRINCIPLE

The people on the floor should spend their time in buyer conversations. The command centre absorbs the coordination, the intelligence refresh and the follow up friction. Judge it on one number: the percentage of the confirmed calendar actually held.

SECTION 08 | CONVERT

Capture in ninety seconds, follow up in twenty four hours.

Most event value is lost in the four days after the show, not during it. The memory of a conversation decays faster than anyone believes, and by the following Monday the person who was in the room can no longer reconstruct what the buyer actually said. Capture has to happen at the show, and the follow up has to be written before anyone travelled.

The 3-2-1 capture rule

Completed within ninety seconds of every meeting, by the person who was in it.

3

FACTS

The pain in the buyer's own words, the business context, and the trigger that made it live now.

2

PEOPLE

The buyer and one other named person in the buying group, plus the internal owner on your side.

1

NEXT STEP

One agreed action with a date attached. A next step without a date is a polite ending, not a next step.

What the first 30 days should look like

WHEN	SEGMENT	ACTION	OWNER
Day 0 to 1	HOT	A personal note from the person who met them, referencing something specific that was said, confirming the agreed next step and proposing a time.	Meeting owner
Day 2 to 5	WARM	The relevant proof point, resource or stakeholder specific follow up promised in the conversation. Sent because it is useful, not because it is day three.	Meeting owner
Week 2	ACTIVE	A second channel: LinkedIn, a call, or an executive note tied to the conversation and aimed at a second person in the buying group.	Campaign owner
Week 3 to 4	NURTURE	Content tied to the priority they expressed, then requalify timing and buying group composition for the next quarter.	Campaign owner

GARTNER IMPLICATION FOR FOLLOW UP

Because consensus predicts deal quality, follow up should help the buying group align rather than persuade one individual. The most effective post event asset is usually something your champion can forward to a peer in a different function without editing it: a shared business case, not a capability deck.

SECTION 09 | MEASURE

Build the business case, then prove it at 90 days.

Use a 90 day portfolio view rather than a three day activity report. The model below is a decision aid, not a promise, so run it as a range.

Expected event value = qualified meetings
x meeting to opportunity rate x opportunity value x win probability

Build three scenarios. Put booth, sponsorship, travel, team time and activation cost on the other side of the ledger, and be honest that team time is the largest hidden number in most event budgets.

SCENARIO	QUALIFIED MEETINGS	MEETING TO OPPORTUNITY	USE IT FOR
Conservative	8 to 12	15% to 20%	The number you commit to the board
Expected	15 to 20	20% to 30%	The plan the team is resourced against
Upside	25 to 35	30% to 40%	The case for a larger footprint next cycle

What to report, and when

REVIEW WINDOW	COMMERCIAL EVIDENCE
Within 24 hours	Meetings held against meetings confirmed, no shows, urgent follow ups sent, named owners, next steps due.
At 14 days	Response rate by tier, second meetings secured, stakeholder expansion inside accounts, opportunities opened.
At 30 days	Qualified opportunities, early pipeline value, nurture status, and what the message data taught you.
At 60 days	Opportunity progression, commercial next steps agreed, account coverage gaps still open.
At 90 days	Event sourced and event influenced pipeline, conversion, lessons, and the reattendance decision for next cycle.

THE INVESTMENT METRIC

Badge scans measure activity. Qualified opportunities, buying group coverage and 90 day pipeline measure whether the event deserved its capital and your executives' time. If the only number available after the show is a scan count, the programme was never built to be measured.

SECTION 10 | THE CONTROL SHEET

The LeadStrategus trade show checklist.

The event owner's weekly control sheet, from approval to the 90 day review. If a box is unchecked, the stage is not done, and the gate in Section 02 has not been passed.

PHASE	WHAT MUST BE TRUE	EVIDENCE AND OWNER
SELECT	☐ ICP, buying roles, geographies and deal economics defined	CEO or CRO
SELECT	☐ Event Fit Score completed on evidence, not reputation	Marketing lead
SELECT	☐ Conservative, expected and upside value scenarios approved	Finance or CRO
BUILD	☐ Attendee universe extracted, deduplicated and tiered	Research owner
BUILD	☐ Buying group mapped for every Tier 1 account	Account owner
BUILD	☐ Current signals and reference proof validated with sources	Research owner
BOOK	☐ 6 to 8 week multi channel sequence launched	Campaign owner
BOOK	☐ Every Tier 1 account has a named owner and a meeting target	Sales leader
BOOK	☐ VIP list identified and each message written individually	Campaign owner
BRIEF	☐ Speaking points written for every confirmed meeting	Intelligence lead
BRIEF	☐ Briefs refreshed within 24 hours of each slot	Intelligence lead
BRIEF	☐ Opening questions and persona language rehearsed	Field team
EXECUTE	☐ Calendar control, no show recovery and daily huddles active	Command centre
EXECUTE	☐ Standby list of 8 to 12 on site Tier 2 contacts held live	Command centre
EXECUTE	☐ 3-2-1 capture completed after every meeting	Meeting owner
CONVERT	☐ Hot lead follow up completed within 24 hours	Meeting owner
CONVERT	☐ Warm and nurture sequences assigned by segment	Campaign owner
MEASURE	☐ 24 hour, 14 day and 30, 60, 90 day reviews scheduled	Executive sponsor
MEASURE	☐ Event portfolio decision recorded for the next cycle	CEO or CRO

RUN IT YOURSELF, OR ASK FOR EXPERT HELP

You can run this checklist in house, and if you do, this document has done its job. If you would rather not build the machinery, we have been doing this across 50 plus events over eight years. LeadStrategus provides event selection intelligence, attendee universe extraction, account and stakeholder mapping, outreach activation, speaking points for every meeting, on ground command centre support and post event conversion.

SECTION 11 | PROOF AND NEXT STEP

What disciplined event ABM produces.

Two programmes, shown as delivered. Both are selected examples rather than standard outcomes.

BSMA Annual Summit 2024

BRUSSELS · BIOTECH AND PHARMA SUPPLY CHAIN

700	280	75	24	18	12
companies researched	qualified prospects	connections	responses	meeting interests	Fortune 50 opportunities

MEDICA 2024

DUSSELDORF · THE WORLD'S LARGEST MEDICAL TRADE FAIR

10,000	8,000+	760	27
records extracted	records enriched	qualified prospects	meeting opportunities

Across a typical large format event programme, this method has produced 50 plus meetings and an indicative pipeline of around US$1 million. Read that as evidence of what is possible with strong fit and disciplined execution, not as a standard result.

PATH ONE

Run it yourself

Start with the free ranking at expotofunnel.com, then use the Event Fit Score, the eight week build, the tiering model, the brief anatomy, the command centre rhythm and the 90 day review to strengthen your next event.

PATH TWO

Ask for a diagnostic

We review one priority event, test account density and reachability against your ICP, size the reachable universe, identify the execution gaps and outline a practical activation plan. Thirty minutes, and a conversation rather than a commitment.

Have a priority event in the next 3 to 6 months?

Request a 30 minute Event to Pipeline Diagnostic: **kingshuk@leadstrategus.com**

Free event ranking: www.expotofunnel.com | www.leadstrategus.com

RESEARCH REFERENCES

1. Gartner. Sales Survey Finds 74% of B2B Buyer Teams Demonstrate Unhealthy Conflict, 7 May 2025. Buying groups of 5 to 16 people; consensus linked to higher quality deals.

2. McKinsey and Company. Global B2B Pulse research, including The Surprising Economics of B2B Growth (2026) and Five Fundamental Truths (2024). Buyers use about ten channels across the journey.

3. CEIR. Effective and Persistent Follow up Leads to New Business. Recommends pre event ownership, fast response and persistent multi touch follow up.

4. Cvent. Event lead generation, personalisation and trade show follow up guidance, 2024 to 2026. Emphasises segmentation, context capture and fast personalised follow up.

5. LeadStrategus. Programme data across 50 plus events, 2018 to 2026, and the internal Event Best Practices playbook.